

Topic: The Rightly Guided Caliphs,

Sub Topic: Umar bin Khattab.

Expansion of Islamic Empire

Q (a) Trace the expansion of the Islamic empire under the rule of the caliph 'Umar. [10]

Structure of Answer	
Para 1	Para 2
➤ Persian Campaign (Against Sassanid Empire) ☐ Back Ground and reasons ☐ Battle of Namaraq ☐ Battle of Bridge ☐ Battle of Buwaib ☐ Battle of Qadisiyyah ☐ Conquest of Mada'in ☐ Battle of Jalula ☐ Battle of Nahavand ☐ Complete Conquest of Persia.	➤ Roman Campaign (Against Byzantine Empire) ☐ Back Ground and reasons ☐ Conquest of Damascus ☐ Battle of Fahl ☐ Conquest of Emesa ☐ Battle of Yarmouk ☐ Surrender of Jerusalem ☐ Conquest of Egypt.
Answer	
☐ Abu Bakr (RA) faced all challenges and cleared the ground for Umar (RA) to expand Islamic empire. ☐ Relationship of Muslims with Persians was never exemplary after the letter sent by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was torn into pieces and army was sent to arrest Holy Prophet (PBUH) by Persian king. ☐ There are traditions according to which Persians helped Musailmah and apostate tribes against Abu Bakr (RA). ☐ The first advancement of Muslims in Persian governed Iraq was under the command of Abu Ubaid Thaqfi along with Muthanna (RA). They successfully defeated Persians at Namaraq. This took place in 13th AH/634 AD. ☐ To avenge the battle of Namaraq, Persians gathered under the command of Bahman Jaduyah. They camped on east bank of Euphrates and Muslims waited for them on the other side. Abu Ubaid Thaqfi rejected suggestions of senior companions and crossed the river. They were not able to assemble properly, Persian army supported by immense elephants thrashed them. Abu Ubaid, his brother Hakam and 7 other who took command one after another, got trampled by elephants. 6 thousand Muslims got martyred in this battle. ☐ Muthanna (RA) avenged this at battle of Buwaib and crushed Persian army led by Mehran. This happened in 14th AH/635 AD. ☐ In the same year Rustam along with famous Persian commanders marched to Qadisiyyah along with 60-80 thousand army. Saad bin Abi Waqas (RA) faced Persians with only 30 thousand soldiers. This battle lasted for 3 days and nights and ended with decisive Muslim victory. This marks the completion of Muslims conquest of Iraq. Soon after this, another historically and strategically important city of Babul was captured by Muslims. ☐ Saad (RA) marched to Mada'in after crossing Tigris river. The fierce advancement of Muslims compelled Yazdegerd to flee the city along with his family and valuables. City fell to Muslims after a siege of some months. ☐ In 16th AH/637 AD Persians gathered at Jalula under the command of Rustam's brother Farrukhzad. Saad (RA) sent 12 thousand Muslim soldiers under the command of Hashim bin Utbah (RA) who defeated Persians after a long siege followed by a fierce battle. ☐ Muslim forces kept marching and seizing small and big Persian cities that almost ended Sassanid rule in Persia. In 21st AH/642 AD Sassanid gathered their remaining final army led by Mardan Shah that was approximately 150 thousand. 30 thousand Muslim soldiers led by Nauman bin Muqrin (RA) marched to Nahavand. After a fierce battle in which hundreds of Muslims along with commander Nauman (RA) got martyred, Muslims managed to crush Persian army killing more than 30 thousand Persians. This marked the end of Sassanid power in Persia and completed Muslim conquest. That why it is called 'Victory of Victories'. ☐ Relation with Romans got disturbed when their governor Shurahbil killed Prophet Muhammad's (PBUH) messenger. Battle of Mautah and later Tabuk took place in order to reply Romans in their language. During Abu Bakr's (RA) era they remained constant threat for Muslims. ☐ As soon as Khalid (RA) reached Rome in 14th AH/635 AD he laid siege around Damascus the capital city of Syria. After	

a long siege, Khalid (RA) managed to enter break into the walls. Seeing this situation romans offered surrender to Abu Ubaidah (RA) and asked for protection. Although, Khalid had captured the city by force but he agreed to give protection on terms set by Abu Ubaidah (RA).

- ☐ Triggered after humiliating defeat at Damascus, Heraclius gathered 40 thousand soldiers under the command of Saqlar in Beisan, Jordan. Abu Ubaidah (RA) and Khalid (RA) defeated them and captured whole Jordan.
- ☐ In the same year of 14th AH/635 AD Muslim army captured very important city of Emesa.
- ☐ In 15th AH/636 AD Heraclius was so much triggered by humiliating defeats at Damascus, Fahl and Emesa. He ordered to gather armies from every corner of the empire and managed to gather an immense army of approx. 200 thousand and ordered to vanish Muslims and Islam from the face of earth. Abu Ubaidah retreated from Emesa and gathered all Muslim armies at Yarmouk and assembled 30-35 thousand soldiers to face this storm. This battle lasted for 6 days and was one of the fiercest battles that ended with decisive Muslim victory and crushed Byzantine forces.
- ☐ In 16th AH/637 AD Muslim army led by Abu Ubaidah (RA) and Amr bin Aas (RA) laid siege around Jerusalem. Jerusalem was surrendered by locals on a condition that Caliph Umar (RA) would visit Jerusalem and write the treaty by himself. Umar (RA) agreed and this historically and strategically important city was captured without any bloodshed.
- ☐ In 20th AH/641 AD Amr bin Aas (RA) entered Egypt that used to be a province of Rome. Muqawqis who was viceroy of Egypt on behalf of Roman Emperor prepared to fight Muslim Army. Umar (RA) sent another 10 thousand soldiers to aid Amr bin Aas (RA). Amr bin Aas (RA) defeated Muqawqis at fort of Fustat and later on captured the famous port city of Alexandria. This marks the completion of Expansion under Umar (RA).

Administrative Measures of Umar (RA)

Q (a) Write a detailed account of the administrative measures put in place by Umar (RA) during his caliphate. [10]

Structure of Answer		
Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
☐ Democratic Government ☐ Majlis-e-Shura and Majlis-e-Aam ☐ Provinces ☐ Aamil (governors) and Waali (Mayors)	☐ Judiciary ☐ Finance ☐ Agriculture ☐ Education	☐ Defense ☐ Other Measures
Answer		
☐ Abu Bakr's (RA) era was very precise and he remained busy in tackling internal and external problems including cross border aggression of Byzantine and Sassanid and mischief of false Prophets and apostate tribes. He did establish a basic administrative structure but could not get time to bring revolutionary measures.		
☐ When Umar (RA) became Caliph on Jamadi-la-Thani 13 th A.H, He paid special attention on maintenance and administration of Islamic Empire. Being an excellent administrator and visionary leader, he transformed the concept of government and came up with an excellent administrative structure that has been an example for rulers in every era.		
☐ First of all, he implemented a systematic chain of authority in order to clarify the domain of every institute. Caliph was the highest authority over whole Islamic Caliphate, then Aamil (governor) was in charge of province and Waali (Mayor) was in charge of districts. Each authority was answerable to the higher authority		
☐ He Formed 2 advisory councils. Majlis-e-Shura consisted most senior, experienced and literate companions. Uthman bin Affan (RA), Ali (RA), Abdul Rahman bin Auf (RA), Muaz bin Jabal (RA), Ubayy bin Ka'ab (RA), Zaid bin Thabit and others were part of it. Majlis-e-Aam comprised of senior Emigrants and Helpers mostly those companions who participated in Battle of Badar.		
☐ He divided the caliphate into 8 provinces for better execution of laws and order and keeping the governors accessible to their people. Those provinces were Hijaz, Iran, Iraq, Syria, Egypt, Palestine, Jazirah and Central Arabia.		
☐ He devised strict rules and regulations for the induction and scrutiny of governors and waali that was the highest		



reason behind excellent governing system of

- ☐ He ensured an independent and transparent judicial system where everyone is treated equally. The Qazi (Judges) were given full authority to deliver justice in time and honestly. Selection criteria and standards of judges were really high and up to the mark. Even judges were allowed to summon any governing figure even the caliph himself if any citizen reported something concerning the caliph.
Some judges of Umar's (RA) era were Abdullah bin Masud (RA) at Kufa, Zaid bin Thabit (RA) at Madinah, Ubadah bin Samit (RA) at Palestine and Ali (RA) was given the special charge of Honorary Judge. People would come to Ali (RA) to get their problems solved. Therefore he was given the title of 'Greatest Judge of Arab'
- ☐ He also focused on finance department and named it Dewan. He refreshed and reconstructed the system of Bait-ul-Maal and Zakat. He introduced taxes: Jizya (defense tax for non-Muslims), Khiraj (Land Tax), Ushr & Khums (Special Tax) and Rikaz (Mines Tax). Tax collection department was crystal clear and transparent. Yearly tax collected from different provinces was:
 - ❖ 10 crore 28 lacs dirham from Iraq
 - ❖ 5 crore 6 lacs dirham from Egypt
 - ❖ 5 crore 80 lacs dirham from Syria.
- ☐ He made use of the barren lands by digging canals that resulted in surprising growth of Agriculture.
- ☐ Education department was also reformed by Umar (RA). He set up new schools and took them under government charge, introduced salaries of teachers and incentives for students. He sent literate companions to every corner of caliphate in order to educate masses.
- ☐ As a strong caliphate requires a strong defense so Umar (RA) reformed Military department.
He introduced new ranks for better control, constructed cantonments and barracks for training, devised attractive salaries and mad army ready to quickly respond to any threat. He would recruit 30 thousand new soldiers every year.
- ☐ Introduced police system for internal safety.
- ☐ He introduced new born baby allowance and old age pension systems.
- ☐ He introduced a very effective Department of Bareed (Post).
- ☐ He devised the mechanism of Hijrah calendar and asked experts to establish the history of Prophet's (PBUH) era and Abu Bakr's (RA) time in backward counting method.
- ☐ He maintained a very strict check on all departments to evaluate their performance and keep the system running flawlessly. He would roam around the streets of Madinah in order to check the condition of his people. He would even disguise and visit random areas of his caliphate in order to check the quality of governing structure. He would punish rulers if found any discrepancy.

Q (b) What do you think was 'Umar's greatest achievement during his rule? Explain why you think so. [4]

Points to be covered

- ☐ The greatest achievement of Umar bin Khattab (RA) was the way he managed a vast country with his great administrative qualities and formed a 'Social Welfare State'.
- ☐ Transparent system of Judiciary, Finance department, scrutiny of governors and mayors ensured that his dream of social welfare state comes true.
- ☐ He did not only appoint excellent officers, but he observed them with hawk eye and took strict action if he ever noticed any mishap.

Q (b) Was 'Umar better as a military leader or as an administrator? [4]

Points to be covered

- ☐ Umar (RA) was a great military leader. He could not lead army by participating on the battle field because of some reasons. But the way he guided and mentored the campaign against Persians and Romans by distributing accurate number of armies, selection of areas to be conquered, instructions about when to advance and when to retreat and other war tactics conveyed to commanders of Muslim army by him, makes him a great military leader.
- ☐ His administration was flawless. The way he managed a gigantic caliphate by appointing worthy governors and mayors, establishing/introducing systems of Finance, Judiciary, Education, Revenue generation and military was highly commendable. He did not prove his mettle in normal situations but the way he managed the great plague and famine and saved millions of lives makes him the greatest administrator of all time.

